Jude 5–11 — Leader / Learner Guide

Three Warnings from History: When Grace Is Misused · Study 3 of 6 · Source: The Gospel Vault

Big Idea and Context

> **Big idea:** God has always answered the abuse of His grace — He judged a redeemed generation, imprisoned angels, and destroyed Sodom. The kept need not fear what falls on those who walk that road.

Jude proves his case from precedent. Three historical judgments (vv. 5–7) are applied to the intruders (vv. 8–10) and summed up in three portraits (v. 11).

- **vv. 5–7:** wilderness generation, angels, Sodom.
- **vv. 8–10:** the intruders: dreaming, defiling, reviling.
- **v. 11:** Cain, Balaam, Korah.

Three Warnings and Three Portraits

Verse	What it says	Teaching point
v. 5	the wilderness generation	Saved out of Egypt, destroyed in the desert — lost the inheritance by unbelief (Num. 14).
v. 6	the angels	Did not keep their domain; God keeps them in eternal bonds. Same root as “kept” in v. 1.
v. 7	Sodom and Gomorrah	An example in the punishment of eternal fire. Cf. Gen. 19.
v. 11	Cain · Balaam · Korah	Own-terms worship · ministry for pay · resisted authority.

Salvation versus inheritance: Free Grace reads the wilderness generation as redeemed people who lost the land; Reformed writers (e.g., Schreiner and Caneday) read it as a warning of loss of salvation. We hold the first reading and test it as we go.

Teaching Flow

1. **Three warnings (vv. 5–7).** Notice the common thread: a place was given and abused.
2. **The pattern applied (vv. 8–10).** “In the same way these men…” — dreaming, defiling, reviling. Michael’s restraint.
3. **Three portraits (v. 11).** Cain, Balaam, Korah — all insiders.
4. **Therefore remember.** God also preserved Noah, Lot, Caleb, and Joshua.

Clarify While Teaching

- **The angels of v. 6:** debated — many connect to Gen. 6:1–4. The point is that they left their proper place.
- **Michael and Moses’ body:** a tradition not recorded in the OT; see Zech. 3:2 for the same words.
- **“Lord” or “Jesus” in v. 5?** Some manuscripts differ; the point is unchanged.
- **Eternal fire (v. 7):** Sodom is an example of the judgment, not a reference to what happened to every inhabitant.

Discussion and Close

1. Which example — wilderness generation, angels, or Sodom — speaks most to your own setting?
2. How can we contend for the faith without railing?
3. How does it change the warnings to remember they are aimed at the intruders, not at the kept?

Close: Point ahead to vv. 12–16: Jude now shows what these men look like. The warnings give way to portraits.